

Sky House Cleaning

Contractor Onboarding Packet

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Becoming a Contractor

Welcome — we're glad you're considering working with Sky House Cleaning. This guide covers what it means to work with us as an independent contractor, and the practical steps to get set up in California.

What It Means to Be a Contractor With Us

As an independent contractor, you're running your own cleaning business — Sky House Cleaning is one of the ways you find work, not an employer. In practice, that means:

- You choose which jobs you take on. We'll offer you jobs based on your availability and location, but you're never required to accept one.
- You're responsible for your own taxes. We don't withhold anything from your pay — you'll receive a 1099 at year-end and are responsible for reporting and paying your own income and self-employment taxes.
- You bring your own tools of the trade and cover your own transportation between jobs.
- You're not eligible for employee benefits (health insurance, paid time off, unemployment insurance) through Sky House Cleaning, since you're not an employee.
- You're expected to hold every job to the same standard, laid out in our [Cleaning Standards Manual](#) and [Service Checklists](#) — that consistency is what our clients count on, no matter who shows up.

Setting Up Your Business

A few things you'll want in place before your first job:

1. Choose a business name

You can operate under your own legal name, or pick a business name for yourself. If you use a name other than your own legal name (like "Bay Area Cleaning Co." instead of your own name), California requires you to file a **Fictitious Business Name (FBN)** statement — sometimes called a "DBA" — with the county clerk where your business is based. Filing is done at the county level, not the state, so requirements and fees vary — check your county clerk's website directly. Most counties also require you to publish the statement in a local newspaper for four consecutive weeks after filing.

2. Get an EIN

An Employer Identification Number (EIN) from the IRS works like a Social Security number for your business. It's free and takes a few minutes at [irs.gov](https://www.irs.gov) — you don't need an accountant or a paid service to get one, and most of the "EIN filing services" you'll find online just charge a fee to do this same free step for you.

3. Open a business bank account

Keeping your business income and expenses separate from your personal accounts makes tax time far simpler, and most banks will ask for your EIN (or your name, if you're operating as a sole proprietor without one) to open one.

4. Get general liability insurance

This covers you if something in a client's home gets damaged or someone gets hurt while you're working. Costs vary by coverage level and provider, but many independent cleaners in California pay somewhere in the range of \$50–\$200/month depending on coverage limits — it's worth getting a few quotes and comparing.

5. Workers' Compensation

If you're a sole proprietor with no employees of your own, California doesn't require you to carry workers' comp coverage on yourself — there's nothing to file or waive in that case. If you set up as an LLC or corporation and are the sole owner, you can typically request a workers' comp exemption/waiver from your insurance carrier once you have a policy in place, so you're not paying to cover yourself as if you were your own employee. Since the exact process depends on how you've structured your business, it's worth a quick call to an insurance agent to confirm what applies to you.

A Note on Legal & Tax Advice

We're not attorneys or accountants, and this guide is meant as a practical starting point, not legal or tax advice. If you have questions specific to your situation, it's worth a conversation with a licensed professional.

Questions?

If any of this is unclear, reach out — call or text us at (801) 759-2044 or email info@skyhousecleaning.com, and we're happy to walk through it with you.

Contractor Pay Structure

Pay is for hours actually worked on-site, and it scales with experience and how consistently you meet our standard. These are starting suggestions — adjust as you get a feel for your market and your team.

Suggested Pay Tiers

Tier	Who this is	Suggested rate
New / Provisional	First few jobs, still learning our standard and checklists	\$22-\$25/hr
Experienced	Reliable, efficient, consistently meets the standard with little to no supervision	\$27-\$33/hr
Lead / Top-Tier	Multiple years of experience, can be trusted with our most demanding jobs, can train or lead others, near-zero callbacks	\$35-\$42/hr

A new contractor typically starts at the bottom of the New/Provisional range and moves up as they build a track record — most contractors would move to the Experienced tier within their first 30–60 days if they're consistently meeting the standard.

A Few Things to Keep in Mind

- **Pay is for time worked, not a flat per-job rate.** If a job is split between two contractors, each is paid for their own hours on-site.
- **Bay Area cost of living.** These ranges assume the Bay Area market — adjust if you're paying for work outside the immediate area.
- **Reliability matters as much as speed.** A contractor who's a little slower but never misses a detail or a shift is worth more than one who's fast but inconsistent — factor that into where someone lands in a tier, not just how quickly they finish.
- **Revisit this periodically.** As you get real data on job times and contractor performance, these ranges are worth revisiting rather than treating as fixed.

Cleaning Standards Manual

This is the standard we hold every visit to, no matter which service it is or who's on the job. Clients trust us because the quality is consistent every single time — that consistency is the whole reason Sky House Cleaning exists.

The Sky House Standard

- **Work top to bottom, back to front.** Dust and debris fall as you clean, so work high surfaces before low ones, and the back of a room before the areas you'll walk back through — that way you're never re-dirtying something you already finished.
- **No shortcuts on the details.** Check corners, baseboards, under furniture you can safely move, and behind items on counters — not just the open, obvious surfaces.
- **Glass and mirrors should be streak-free,** not just wiped. Take the extra minute.
- **Put things back exactly where you found them.** If you move something to clean under or around it, it goes back in its original spot.
- **Leave no trace you were there** — except a clean home. Take your trash out with you unless a client has asked you to empty theirs, and don't leave rags, bottles, or equipment behind.
- **If something's broken, missing, or looks off, say something.** Flag it to the client (or to us, if you're not comfortable raising it directly) before you leave — don't just clean around it and hope it's not noticed.
- **If you're not sure, ask — don't skip it.** A quick question is always better than guessing and getting it wrong.
- **Respect the home.** Shoes off or booties on if asked, no personal calls while you're working, keep personal items to a minimum, and make sure everything is locked up the way you found it when you leave.

What We Offer

Every service has its own detailed checklist — see [Service Checklists](#) for the full room-by-room breakdown of each one:

- **One-Time Cleaning** — a standard reset clean for the kitchen, bathrooms, living areas, and the whole home.
- **Recurring Cleaning** — the same standard clean, on a weekly, bi-weekly, or monthly schedule.
- **Deep Cleaning** — everything in a standard clean, plus interior cabinets, appliances, walls, baseboards, and interior windows.
- **Move-In / Move-Out Cleaning** — the same expanded scope as Deep Cleaning, for a home in transition.
- **Interior Car Detailing** — a full interior detail: seats, carpets, trunk, dash, console, and door panels.
- **Garage Cleaning & Organization** — decluttering, zone-based organizing, and a full clean of the space.
- **Office & Commercial Cleaning** — recurring janitorial cleaning for offices and small businesses.
- **Post-Construction Cleaning** — a rough clean followed by a final detailed clean for new builds, renovations, and remodels.
- **Airbnb Cleaning** — fast turnover cleaning between guests, so a listing is spotless and guest-ready every time.

Whatever the job, the standard above applies across all of them — the checklists tell you *what* to

clean; this page is about *how* we clean it.

Service Checklists

A room-by-room checklist for every service we offer. These match what's promised on the website, so completing every item is what "done" looks like on a Sky House Cleaning job.

One-Time & Recurring Cleaning

Kitchen

- ☐ Wipe down and spot-clean cabinet faces
- ☐ Clean the stovetop, burners, and drip pans
- ☐ Freshen the inside of the microwave
- ☐ Clean the exterior of appliances
- ☐ Polish the sink and wipe counters and backsplash

Bathrooms

- ☐ Thoroughly scrub sinks, toilets, tubs, and showers
- ☐ Polish faucets and mirrors
- ☐ Wipe counters and cabinet fronts

Living Areas & Bedrooms

- ☐ Tidy pillows, blankets, and common areas
- ☐ Make beds (if fresh linens are left out)
- ☐ Dust shelves and blinds
- ☐ Wipe window sills
- ☐ Clean the glass sliding door (if the home has one)

Throughout the Home

- ☐ Vacuum carpets and sweep/mop hard surfaces
- ☐ Dust interior shelves and closets
- ☐ Wipe down handrails

Deep Cleaning & Move-In / Move-Out Cleaning

Everything above, plus:

Kitchen

- ☐ Clean the interior of cabinets and drawers
- ☐ Clean the interior of appliances (oven, refrigerator, dishwasher)

Bathrooms

- ☐ Clean the interior of cabinets and drawers

Living Areas & Bedrooms

- ☐ Wipe down ceiling fans

Throughout the Home

- ☐ Wipe down walls and baseboards
- ☐ Clean interior windows
- ☐ Clean the glass sliding door

Garage Cleaning & Organization

Organization

- ☐ Sort and declutter items with the client's input (keep, donate, discard)
- ☐ Group items into zones that make sense for them (tools, sports gear, seasonal items, and more)
- ☐ Set up or improve shelving, bins, and storage systems
- ☐ Label bins and storage areas so it's easy to keep up

Cleaning

- ☐ Sweep and mop the garage floor
- ☐ Wipe down shelves, workbenches, and storage units
- ☐ Clear cobwebs and dust corners, rafters, and light fixtures
- ☐ Wipe down the interior of cabinets and storage bins

Interior Car Detailing

Interior Detailing

- ☐ Full vacuum of seats, carpets, and trunk
- ☐ Wipe down all interior surfaces, including the dash, console, and door panels
- ☐ Clean interior glass and mirrors
- ☐ Spot-treat stains on fabric seats and upholstery
- ☐ Wipe down leather and vinyl surfaces
- ☐ Clean cup holders, vents, and other tight spots

Office & Commercial Cleaning

General Cleaning

- ☐ Empty trash and replace liners
- ☐ Vacuum carpets and mop hard floors
- ☐ Dust desks, surfaces, and furniture
- ☐ Wipe down and disinfect high-touch surfaces (door handles, light switches, handrails)
- ☐ Clean interior glass, mirrors, and partitions

Restrooms, Break Rooms & Common Areas

- ☐ Clean and disinfect toilets, sinks, and countertops
- ☐ Restock paper towels, toilet paper, and soap when supplies are left on-site

- ☐ Wipe down break room counters, tables, and the exterior of appliances
- ☐ Empty and reline trash bins
- ☐ Wipe down reception desks and shared furniture near entrances

Post-Construction Cleaning

Rough Clean

- ☐ Remove construction debris, packaging, and leftover materials
- ☐ Sweep and vacuum up dust and debris from floors
- ☐ Wipe down dust from surfaces, sills, and ledges
- ☐ Clean windows and glass of construction dust, stickers, and labels

Final Clean

- ☐ Detailed cleaning of kitchens and bathrooms, including inside cabinets and drawers
- ☐ Wipe down all surfaces, baseboards, and trim
- ☐ Clean interior windows, tracks, and sills
- ☐ Vacuum carpets and mop hard floors
- ☐ Wipe down light fixtures and switch plates
- ☐ Remove any remaining dust, stickers, or residue

Airbnb Cleaning

Turnover Cleaning

- ☐ Full clean of the kitchen, bathrooms, bedrooms, and living areas between every guest
- ☐ Strip used linens and remake every bed with fresh ones
- ☐ Wash, dry, and restock towels
- ☐ Vacuum and mop all floors
- ☐ Take out trash and reset recycling

Guest-Ready Touches

- ☐ Restock guest essentials like toilet paper, paper towels, soap, and coffee
- ☐ Fluff pillows, straighten throws, and reset staged decor
- ☐ Wipe down and spot-check appliances
- ☐ Quick walkthrough to flag any damage, missing items, or maintenance issues
- ☐ Turn the space around fast between checkout and check-in

Approved Cleaning Supplies

We're picky about what goes into a client's home, and that applies no matter whose bottle it comes out of. Whether you're using supplies we provide or bringing your own, every product used on a Sky House Cleaning job needs to meet this standard:

- **EWG-rated for safety** — scores well with the Environmental Working Group, so there's nothing harsh or hidden in what's being used.
- **Eco-friendly, plant-based formulas** — biodegradable, made from plant-based or naturally occurring ingredients.
- **Vegan and cruelty-free** — nothing tested on animals or made with animal-derived ingredients.
- **Gentle, but still effective** — cuts through dirt, grime, and everyday buildup without harsh chemicals, and is safe to have around kids and pets.

If you're ever unsure whether a product meets this bar, check it against the [EWG Guide to Healthy Cleaning](#) before bringing it into a client's home, or reach out and we'll point you to our approved list.

What You'll Typically Need

- All-purpose surface cleaner
- Glass & mirror cleaner (streak-free, ammonia-free)
- Bathroom cleaner (for soap scum and hard water buildup)
- Kitchen degreaser
- Wood floor cleaner
- Microfiber cloths — ideally color-coded by area (e.g., one color for bathrooms, another for kitchens, another for general dusting) to avoid cross-contaminating surfaces between rooms
- Vacuum with a HEPA filter
- Mop and microfiber mop pads
- Rubber gloves
- Trash bags

Never bring bleach, ammonia-based cleaners, or anything with a harsh chemical odor into a client's home — if a job seems to call for something stronger than our standard allows, flag it to us rather than reaching for it yourself.

Dress Code

Simple and consistent: **all black.**

- Solid black top and bottom
- Closed-toe, non-slip shoes (you're on your feet on all kinds of floors, so this is as much about safety as it is looks)
- Clean and presentable — you're representing Sky House Cleaning in someone's home or business

If you'd like a Sky House Cleaning logo t-shirt, just ask — we're happy to provide one.